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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Submitter Information

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General Comment

I am an American who lives for making visual arts, with my own hands, and dreams of making a living through it. I have dedicated my life to honing my craft.

If AI is allowed to run rampant, scraping all works with no regard for American copyrights, turning a profit off of this business model, it would go against the American Dream itself. We have the rights to copyright protection, and thus AI focused companies should respect those rights.

Lack of copyright respect would kill many small businesses, whether it be graphics design or drawing-focused businesses like graphic novels and commissioned artwork. It is antithetical to the American Dream to kill small businesses by fueling one or few giant businesses with work directly stolen copyrighted material from small businesses and visual artists.

The United States of America is built on innovation. Copyright law exists to encourage innovations. What point is there for us artists to innovate if AI models trample our rights and put us out of business? If you wish to maintain innovation, do not infringe on the rights of creators; protect the rights of creators so that they can comfortably innovate in the first place and potentially give AI technology material that is backed by consent.

I am not against the existence of AI technology. It undoubtedly has important uses. However, it should not be built off the backs of artists who don't consent to having their work scraped by a machine.

The AI Action Plan should:

- Demand AI focused companies have explicit consent from the copyright holders of any material they use.
- Encourage the existence of a system where copyright holders can license their materials out to AI focused companies for payment.
- Demand transparency from AI focused companies as to what material is in their systems.

A system where AI companies flourish on the backs of artists who give no consent is not sustainable. If artists and small businesses focused on the arts feel secure, they will keep making innovations in the arts, and thus give better quality material to the AI.